

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Monday, April 6, 2026, at 6:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Charisse Fain Commissioners: Yolanda J. Feimster, R. Dan Brummitt, Leo Kelly, Jr., Thomas S. Hester, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Dywanda Pettaway.

Rev. Dr. John Joyner gave the invocation.

Public comments were heard first. There were four individuals that signed up to speak. They were Tim Price, Kelly Lee, John Claborne, and Ann Rivera.

Ms. Sandra Wilkerson, Chamber of Commerce, recognized the participants of Leadership-Vance 2026 who were present. The participants introduced themselves and stated their occupation and place of work. Chair Carolyn Faines thanked the group for being present at the meeting and for taking an interest in county government.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team Chair, was next on the agenda to recognize the new employee of the month. He noted that employees are nominated by their peers, and this month's recognition goes to Ms. Stephanie Williams, Financial Director. Ms. Williams will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. She was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board congratulated her on receiving this recognition.

Austin Eubanks, an auditor from Thompson, Price, Scott, Adams, & Co. was next on the agenda and presented the Fiscal Year 2025-2026 Audit Report Presentation to the commissioners for approval.

Following discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous to accept the FY 2025-26 audit as presented.

At this time, Paul Ross of Triangle North Healthcare Foundation, appeared before the board and provided information on the progress of the new YMCA. He noted that this is a top notch, \$20 plus million-dollar project. This building is going to bring forth many new amenities that the

community is going to enjoy. But the lenders want all restrictions removed in the event they had to foreclose. They don't want a first writer refusal to go back to the county. They want to be able to recruit their funding if that happens. Henderson Vance Healthcare is going to guarantee the loan. So, it's not going to happen. But they're lawyers, and unfortunately, I speak that lawyer stuff. They want a clean title. They want the property without restrictions, reversionary rights back to the county. This could potentially be accomplished through a um a release that basically subrogated to the bank, but the banks really would prefer just a clean title that they are put in a first lien position with. And so, our request to the county is that you completely remove those restrictions in favor of the YMCA for this project moving forward.

After discussion with board of commissioners and board attorney, the board attorney stated that he came prepared tonight to be in favor of a subordination request to subordinate to their deed of trust. So, if they're asking for a full removal, then he need to research that. So, it was decided that no action be taken tonight. This would allow the board attorney time to further investigate what the details are in reference to completely removing all restrictions as requested.

As advertised, a public hearing was held to review and make a recommendation regarding a Zoning Map Amendment (ZMA) request for the parcel of property located off Hwy 158 Business. To rezone the property from Employment and Institutional Area (E-I-A) to Light Industrial (L-I). Planning Director Sherry Moss noted that the purpose of the public hearing is to receive the Planning Board recommendation, staff and public comments, and take formal action on the following Zoning Map Amendments: Case ZMA26-001: Patricia Galloway (Owner)/ Michael Natelli & Beth Trahos (Applicants): Request to rezone parcel 0414 01005 (40+/- acres) from EIA (Employee Institutional Area) zoning to L-I (Light Industrial) zoning off Hwy 158 Business. On February 12, 2026, planning board meeting, the Planning Board voted unanimously to recommend approval of rezoning requests ZMA26-001, finding the rezoning was compliant with the adopted Vance County Comprehensive Plan and was reasonable and in the public interest.

There were 17 individuals who wished to speak on this matter. All individuals were given three minutes to speak on this matter. Once all individuals spoke, Chair Carolyn Faines declared the public hearing closed.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimously, to continue rezoning request for further consideration by the Board.

Water District Board

At 8:34 p.m., Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order.

The February 2026 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information.

Phase 1B Change Order. Zach Bennett of LKC Engineering presented to the water district board for consideration of approval an update on the Phase 1B change order. LKC's recommendation is for the board to consider approving the change order #3 to contract 1 of the Phase 1B project, pending final approval by USDA and NCDEQ as presented.

Following the presentation and discussion, a motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve Change Order #3 to Contract 1 of the Phase 1B project, pending final approval by USDA and NCDEQ as presented.

Zach Bennett of LKC Engineering also presented to the water district board for consideration of approval an update on the construction project budget for Phase 1B. The update included adding an additional Engineering Service Agreement (ESA #2) in the amount of \$68,000 to the construction project budget.

Following presentation and discussion, a motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. and seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote was unanimous, to approve Amendment #2 to LKC's Engineering Services Agreement, pending final approval by USDA and NCDEQ as presented.

Issuance Resolution Bond – Vance County Phase 1B. Ms. Stephanie Williams, Finance and Budget Director presented to the water district board the Issuance Resolution Bond for Vance County Phase 1B. It was noted that this resolution is the title of which was read and previously distributed to each commissioner. It is a series resolution providing for the sale and issuance of a \$1,672,000 water system revenue bond, series 2026 (Phase 1B).

Following the presentation and discussion, a motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. and seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the foregoing resolution providing for the sale and issuance of a \$1,672,000 water system revenue bond, series 2026 (Phase 1B) as presented.

At 8:51p.m., Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

Work Session Report and Recommendations

The board held a work session on Tuesday, March 17, 2026. County Manager C. Renee Perry provided the following report and recommendations.

Solid Waste Fee Waiver Policy. Ms. Perry stated that historically, prior budget ordinance language allowed for limited exemptions under specific conditions for the solid waste household user fee; however, that language has not been in effect for several years and was formally removed due to the absence of an adopted policy and administrative framework to support consistent implementation. The Vance County Board of Commissioners discussed this matter during the March 17, 2026, work session and reached a consensus not to reinstate the prior exemption provisions. As a result, the Solid Waste Household User Fee remains applicable to all qualifying properties, and no waivers are currently authorized. This was for informational purposes only.

Artificial Intelligence Policy. IT Director Randall Medlin presented a proposed Artificial Intelligence (AI) policy to the Board of County Commissioners, emphasizing the need for the policy to address data security, confidentiality, and appropriate use, while ensuring consistent practices across departments. He also reviewed the scope of the proposed policy. Recommendation is to approve the AI policy effective April 6, 2026.

A motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. , vote was unanimous, to approve the AI policy effective April 6, 2026.

Board of Equalization and Review. Ms. Perry stated that the Board of County Commissioners reached consensus to move forward by establishing a separate Board of Equalization and Review (BER) in advance of the 2030 property revaluation, in accordance with G.S. § 105-322. This action will allow the County to better manage the volume and complexity of property valuation appeals, while maintaining a clear separation between the Board's policy-making role and quasi-judicial responsibilities. Establishing separate BER is expected to improve efficiency, promote fairness and transparency in the appeals process, and reduce the administrative burden on the Board during the revaluation cycle. Staff will return to the Board before July 1, 2026, with a proposed resolution, recommendations for member qualifications, and a plan for public recruitment to ensure appropriate representation and readiness ahead of the 2030 revaluation. This was for informational purposes only.

Health Insurance. Ms. Perry reported that for more than 25 years, Vance County has provided employee-only health insurance at no cost to employees; however, rising healthcare costs have made this benefit increasingly unsustainable. During the current fiscal year, the County

experienced a \$1.2 million increase (3 cents) in health insurance expenses, with an additional 5% increase projected for FY 2026–2027, bringing the total anticipated cost to approximately \$4.2 million. The County currently pays about \$13,000 per employee annually under its self-funded plan. Staff conducted an employee survey and presented comparative data from other counties and municipalities to inform this recommendation. While some Tier 1 counties may continue to offer no-cost employee health insurance, staff does not have access to their internal utilization rates, expenditures, or overall financial structures to determine how those offerings compare to Vance County’s actual costs and fiscal capacity. To help offset rising costs, staff is recommending the implementation of a \$50 per month employee pre-tax premium for employee-only coverage. This amount would be paid by employees on a pre-tax basis, reducing their taxable income, and is estimated to generate approximately \$225,000 annually. While this will not fully offset the increase, it will help reduce pressure on the General Fund and allow the County to continue addressing compensation and operational needs. To balance this change and remain competitive in recruitment and retention, staff is also proposing enhancements to the overall compensation package, including a 3% COLA effective July 1, 2026, performance-based pay, birthday leave, and vacation accrual adjustments based on credible service in the retirement system. Additionally, staff recommends that the \$50 monthly premium not apply to current retirees, as they retired with the expectation of no-cost health coverage; however, the premium would apply to eligible employees retiring on or after July 1, 2026. Staff will update the personnel policy accordingly to reflect these changes. The recommendation is to approve the implementation of a \$50 monthly employee health insurance premium, effective July 1, 2026, and direct staff to update the premium structure accordingly. The premium shall not apply to current retirees; however, it will apply to eligible employees retiring on or after July 1, 2026. Staff will revise the personnel policy to reflect these changes and bring the policy back to the Board of Commissioners for approval along with other changes in the future.

A motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, votes passed with 4-2, (Commissioners Faines, Fain, Hester, and Kelly voting yes) (Commissioners Feimster and Brummitt voting no) to approve the implementation of a \$50 monthly employee health insurance premium, effective July 1, 2026, and direct staff to update the premium structure accordingly. The premium shall not apply to current retirees; however, it will apply to eligible employees retiring on or after July 1, 2026. Staff will revise the personnel policy

THIS, the 6th day of April 2026.

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Motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the following proclamation recognizing April 12 - 18, 2026 as National Animal Care and Control Officer Appreciation Week in Vance County.

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THIS, the 6th day of April 2026.

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Following a discussion, a motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. , and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote passed with 5-1 (Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt voting no) to approve the contract for the Assistant Medical Director subject to board attorney's final approval.

Auditor Recommendation. Ms. Williams stated that the purpose of this memorandum is to present the results of the Request for Proposals (RFP) process for audit services and to recommend the award of a contract for these services. The County issued a Request for Proposals to invite qualified individual auditors having sufficient governmental accounting and auditing experience in performing an audit in accordance with Generally Accepted Auditing Standards (GAAS); Government Auditing Standards (2024 Revision) issued by the Comptroller General of the United States; Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Part 200 (Uniform Guidance) for federal awards; the North Carolina State Single Audit Implementation Act; Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB) pronouncements; and all other applicable federal, state, and local laws, regulations, and compliance requirements. The objective was to select a firm with the qualifications, experience, and resources necessary to provide high-quality, timely, and compliant audit services.

The RFP was publicly advertised on Vance County's website and through the NC Finance Connect Community listserv. We received three (3) proposals and five (5) responses that either no longer audit counties, have too commitments and/or do not have the staffing capacity to serve

us at this time. Proposals were received from the following firms: Thompson, Price, Scott, Adams & Co., P.A. (TSPA), RH CPAs, LLC, and Belinda Johnson. CPA, PA.

Staff recommends that the Board of County Commissioners award the audit services contract to TSPA as the most responsive and responsible proposer, providing the best overall value to the County. Staff further requests authorization for the County Manager to execute the necessary contract documents.

Following a discussion, a motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. and seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote passed 5-1 (Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt voting no) to award the audit services contract to TSPA as the most responsive and responsible proposer, providing the best overall value to the County and grant authorization for the County Manager to execute the necessary contract documents.

Updated Bank Depository. Ms. Williams stated So, uh, pursuant to North Carolina General Statute 159-31, the board of commissioners is required to designate one or more official depositories for the deposit of public funds. A couple months ago, a bank depository was approved without having a community bank reflected. So, in order to add a community bank, it has to be brought back to the board of county commissioners for approval. The depositories that were initially presented prior to was Truist Bank, First National Bank, PNC Bank, and JP Chase Morgan So, the recommendation is to approve the resolution, keeping those four banks reflected and add Benchmark Community Bank as the fifth bank.

A motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. and seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote was unanimous, to approve the resolution, keeping those four banks reflected and add Benchmark Community Bank as the fifth bank.

County Manager's Report

County Government Month Proclamation. County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that National County Government Month, held each April, is an annual celebration of county government. It is an excellent opportunity to recognize the hard work and dedication of county employees. The recommendation is to approve the proclamation recognizing April 2026 as County Government Month in Vance County.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. , vote was unanimous, to approve the proclamation recognizing April 2026 as County Government Month in Vance County.



PROCLAMATION
by the
Vance County Board of Commissioners
in recognition of
County Government Month

WHEREAS, the nation’s 3,069 counties serving more than 330 million Americans provide essential services to create healthy, safe, and vibrant communities; and

WHEREAS, counties fulfill a vast range of responsibilities and deliver services that touch nearly every aspect of our citizens’ lives; and

WHEREAS, Vance County and all counties take pride in our responsibility to protect and enhance the health, well-being and safety of our citizens in efficient and cost-effective ways; and

WHEREAS, in order to remain healthy, vibrant, safe, and economically competitive, counties provide human services, justice, emergency management, and economic services that play a key role in everything from citizens’ daily health to disaster response; and

WHEREAS, each year since 1991 the National Association of Counties has encouraged counties across the country to elevate awareness of county responsibilities, programs and services.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT PROCLAIMED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does hereby recognize April 2026 as County Government Month and encourages all county officials, employees, schools, and citizens to participate in county government celebration activities.

THIS, the 6th day of April 2026.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair



Spring Litter Sweep Proclamation. Ms. Perry stated that In the spring and fall of each year, the NC Department of Transportation (NC DOT) sponsors cleanup campaigns to beautify the roadsides of the state. This year, DOT is sponsoring its Spring Litter Sweep Campaign on April 11 - 25, 2026. The recommendation is to approve the proclamation designating April 11 – 25, 2026 as Spring Litter Sweep in Vance County.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to approve the proclamation designating April 11 – 25, 2026 as Spring Litter Sweep in Vance County.



PROCLAMATION
by the
Vance County Board of Commissioners
in recognition of
2026 Spring Litter Sweep

WHEREAS, in conjunction with the North Carolina Department of Transportation, Vance County supports and encourages participation in the Spring 2026 roadside cleanup effort to ensure clean and beautiful roads throughout the County; and

WHEREAS, the Spring 2026 Litter Sweep roadside cleanup campaign will occur April 11 - 25. The County urges all communities, civic and professional groups, businesses, churches, schools, families, and individual citizens to participate in the cleanup effort by sponsoring and organizing roadside cleanup teams; and

WHEREAS, Adopt-A-Highway volunteers, community service workers, community leaders, civic and community organizations, businesses, churches, schools, and environmentally concerned citizens conduct local cleanups during Litter Sweep and may receive Certificates of Appreciation for participation; and

WHEREAS, the natural beauty of our State and County, in addition to a clean environment, is a source of great pride for all Vance County residents, attracting tourists and aiding in the recruiting of new industries; and

WHEREAS, the cleanup effort will increase the awareness of the need for cleaner roadsides, emphasize the importance of anti-litter campaigns, and emphasize the recycling of solid wastes such as glass, metals, and plastics; and

WHEREAS, the Litter Sweep cleanup will be a part of educating the children and citizens of the County regarding the importance of a clean environment to the quality of life in Vance County.

NOW, THEREFORE BE IT PROCLAIMED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does hereby recognize April 11 - 25, 2026 as “Spring Litter Sweep” in Vance County and encourages all citizens to take an active role in making the community a cleaner and more beautiful place in which to live.

THIS, the 6th day of April 2026.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair

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Line Worker Appreciation Day Proclamation. Ms. Perry stated that National Lineman Appreciation Day is celebrated annually on April 18th. This day honors the hard work, innovation, and dedication of America's electrical line workers who work in often dangerous conditions to keep the power flowing. The recommendation is to approve the proclamation recognizing April 18, 2026, as Line Worker Appreciation Day in Vance County.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr. , vote was unanimous, to approve the proclamation recognizing April 18, 2026, as Line Worker Appreciation Day in Vance County.

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PROCLAMATION
by the
Vance County Board of Commissioners
in recognition of
Line Worker Appreciation Day

WHEREAS, on April 10, 2013, a resolution was passed in the United States Senate to recognize April 18 annually as National Lineman (Line Worker) Appreciation Day; and

WHEREAS, the profession of the electrical line worker is steeped in personal, family, and professional tradition; and

WHEREAS, line workers are often first responders during storms and other catastrophic events, working to make the scene safe for other public safety officials, and to expedite the return of vital electrical power to our communities; and

WHEREAS, these brave men and women work with thousands of volts of electricity high atop power lines 24 hours a day, 365 days a year, risking and sometimes losing their lives to keep electricity flowing; and

WHEREAS, line workers are often faced with dangerous conditions, far from their families, as they work to construct and maintain energy infrastructure throughout the State of North Carolina and the United States; and

WHEREAS, line workers must use their technical knowledge, physical strength and ingenuity to achieve success in challenges they face every day; and

WHEREAS, the Vance County Board of Commissioners thanks these skilled and heroic line workers who brave hurricanes, ice storms, snowstorms, and other natural disasters to maintain our community’s energy grid.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT PROCLAIMED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does hereby recognize April 18, 2026, as Line Worker Appreciation Day in Vance County.

THIS, the 6th day of April 2026

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair

Consent Agenda

After clarification of Budget Amendments #29 and #33, motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: Budget Amendments #29, #30, #31, #32, and #33, February 2026 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the March 2, 2026 regular meeting, and the March 17, 2026 work session.

Budget Amendment #29
FY 2025-2026
DSS; Program on Aging

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	1,909,450
State Foster Care	10-348-434808	11,972
SHIIP Grant Revenue	10-349-434904	2,582
IV-D Incentive	10-349-434901	63,249

Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$ 10,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Triangle North Healthcare Expense	10-605-500100	10,000
Total		\$ 10,000

Purpose: Approval for acceptance of a \$10,000 Grant from Triangle North Healthcare Grant to Cooperative Extension for the parenting program - Supporting Fatherhood Involvement-SFI. There is no matching requirement for this grant.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
April 6, 2026

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Budget Amendment #32
FY 2025-2026
Veteran’s Affairs

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
NCDMVA Grant Revenue	10-346-434605	18,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$18,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
NCDMVA Grant Expense	10-607-500046	18, 000
Total		\$18,000

Purpose: Approval to accept NC Department of Military Veterans Affairs Grant for Veteran’s Affairs. There are no matching requirements for this grant.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
April 6, 2026

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Budget Amendment #33
FY 2025-2026

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance	10-399-439900	1,672,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Transfer to Fund 13	10-696-500130	1,672,000
Finance Department		
Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Transfer from General Fund	13-397-439710	1,672,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$1,672,000

Board of Commissioners had to choose from the following applicants to fill the vacant seat: Ralph Nevils III, Melissa C. Lemmond, Brandon J. Link, Darlynn P. Oxendine, Pamela W. Hester, Betty T. Boyd, Sean A. Alston, Sr., and Robert D. Brummitt.

Following discussion and deliberation, a motion was made by Commissioner Yolanda Feimster and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote passed 4-2 (Commissioners Tommy Hester, Jr. and Leo Kelly, Jr. voting no) to appoint Sean A. Alston, Sr. to fill the vacant seat on the ABC Board.

VGCC Board of Trustee – four-year term

Reappoint Danny Wright

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to reappoint Danny Wright for the VGCC Board of Trustee.

At 9:22 p.m., a motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to enter into closed session for property matters.

Upon return to open session, motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., and seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote passed 5-1 (Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt voting no) to approve the purchase of and enter into a contract with the state to purchase the property for \$110,000 for a potential new jail location.

A motion was then made by Commissioner Charisse Fain and seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the purchase of and entering into a contract for purchase of Tax Parcel 0212 010011, the tower land in the amount of \$120,000.00

A motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain and seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve all minutes of the March 2, 2026, closed sessions.

As there was no further business, at 9:29 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain and seconded by Commissioner Yolanda Feimster, vote was unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed May 4, 2026.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair